BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #51 · APPEARANCE AND BODY IMAGE

“I'm ugly, so I'm unlovable.”

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Where it often comes from

Teasing, rejection, or constant exposure to idealized images can tie lovability to looks. After a few hurtful experiences, “I’m ugly” becomes “I’m unlovable.”

What Scripture teaches

“God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us.” His love came before our worth was visible to anyone. “Man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.” “I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made.” Love in Scripture is not a reward for beauty. “Love is patient, love is kind.” People who love you see far more than your face.

> *“But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us”* (Romans 5:8).

Also see

> “But the LORD said to Samuel, ‘Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.’” (1 Samuel 16:7).

> “I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:14).

> “Love is patient, love is kind. It does not envy, it does not boast, it is not proud” (1 Corinthians 13:4).

> “The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing” (Zephaniah 3:17).

Common self-statements

- No one could love me.
- My face makes me unlovable.
- I will be alone.
- Beauty is necessary for love.
- I am too ugly for anyone.
- I do not deserve love.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either beautiful or unlovable.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that no one will love me.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling ugly and concluding I am unlovable.
- Labeling: Calling myself ugly.

Challenging questions

- Who loves me, and does it depend on my looks?
- What do I love about the people dear to me?

- Who taught me that love follows beauty?
- What does God's love for me look like?
- What qualities in me are lovable?
- What would change if I believed I was loved?

Truth summary

> God loved me before I did anything. Love is not a prize for beauty. I am lovable now, and I can receive love from God and from people.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love, By God
- Pride
- Loneliness
- Grace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm ugly, so I'm unlovable"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm ugly, so I'm unlovable." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who loves me, and does it depend on my looks?
- ☐ What do I love about the people dear to me?
- ☐ Who taught me that love follows beauty?
- ☐ What does God's love for me look like?
- ☐ What qualities in me are lovable?
- ☐ What would change if I believed I was loved?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God loved me while I was a sinner.
- ☐ God sees my heart.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ Love is patient and kind.
- ☐ God rejoices over me.
- ☐ I am lovable.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Romans 5:8
  "But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us."
- ☐ 1 Samuel 16:7
  "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'"
- ☐ Psalm 139:14
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Loved as I am: Each week, note one sign of love you received.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 5:8 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God loved me while I was still a sinner.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List your lovers. Write those who love you.
- [ ] List lovable traits. Write ten qualities that are not about looks.
- [ ] Receive love. Say thank you to compliments.
- [ ] Read Romans 5:8. Let it settle in.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm ugly, so I'm unlovable": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Loved as I am
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm ugly, so I'm unlovable.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You loved me before I was lovely. Heal my sense of being unlovable, and let me receive love. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.